



S7 Edge Batman edition

Celebrating the 3rd anniversary of Injustice: Gods Among Us, Samsung has released a Galaxy S7 Edge Injustice Edition. <http://digit.in/BtmnS7E>



RIP Thunderbolt monitor

Apple will discontinue making Thunderbolt displays, without announcing a replacement for it. <http://digit.in/thunderboltx>

Bazaar

LeEco Le Max 2

Tres Bon

Chinese LeEco has managed to gain quite a following in India recently. But while the company's Le 1s smartphone was widely appreciated, the same can't be said about the Le Max. LeEco has learned from those mistakes, though, making a much better device this time.

Where the Le Max was a big tablet-like device, the Le Max 2 is more ergonomic, but still big. The bezel size has been reduced, and the display this time is a 5.7 inch unit, which reduces the overall footprint of the phone. It's much easier to carry around now and fits in your pocket better. Of course, it's still not meant for single handed usage, but it's a more ergonomically built phablet than its predecessor. It's a solidly built phone, which feels nice and there's no misalignment or other nicks in the design.

The Le Max 2 is also one of only two phones in India, that come with 6GB of RAM. We ran four heavy games, shot and edited a 4K video, ran an audio editor, and a photo editor, but were unable to exhaust the phone's memory. This is accompanied by the fast Snapdragon 820 SoC, which handles anything you throw at it.

However, the Le Max 2 tends to heat up quite easily. Like the HTC 10, this phone also reaches temperatures above 40 degrees quite easily, even in an air conditioned room. Shooting a 4K video for 10 minutes took the temperature up to 42 degrees, which isn't abnormal, but also didn't happen on phones like the LG G5 and OnePlus 3. To be clear, we didn't find any thermal throttling problems.

The CDLA feature on the LeEco Le Max 2 is interesting. While lossless audio is good on paper, LeEco's self manufactured CDLA headphones aren't very good. The audio is bright and warm, but there is no clarity across frequency ranges, and audio sounds muddled. CDLA technology itself has potential, but LeEco's implementation doesn't seem to be the best. Fortunately, you get a convertor in the box, which allows you to use your regular 3.5mm audio products with the phone.



Price
₹22,999

You won't get lossless audio with these, though.

Further, while the LeEco Le Max 2 has an improved camera, there's still work to be done. The 21MP camera takes good shot, with good dynamic range, and satisfactory colours. However, the camera tends to dull photos down a little bit. It's also refuses to focus at times, which is an issue. This becomes even more annoying when shooting videos. The phone sometimes refused to focus while shooting a video.

In terms of battery life, the LeEco Le Max 2 lasts for about 12-16 hours on heavy usage, including a lot of gaming. The QHD display, combined with the Snapdragon 820 reduces battery life, but for most users, it should last for a work day.

LeEco's content integration plays a big role in the value proposition of this device. You get a year-long subscription to Le Live and Le Vidi, the two apps responsible for

delivering the content. This, in turn gives you access to YuppTV and Eros Now.

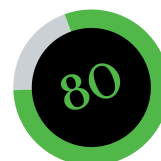
While the former brings live TV channels, the latter brings an impressive collection of movies. The apps have been deeply integrated into eUI, making them feel like a part of the OS, with no lags in loading or beginning a stream. You will need a high FUP connection to make good use of this phone, though.

The display lacks brightness, but is very good at colour reproduction, which is important for watching videos and movies. It's not ideal for outdoor viewing, but works fine indoors.

Overall, the LeEco Le Max 2 is an impressive smartphone, offering very good value at its selling price. It would have scored higher had the OnePlus 3 not come swooping in and raise the bar. It's well built and performs well, and the year long content subscription is a good deal, especially considering that the content offerings will keep growing in coming months.

It's not the best phone in this price range, but it's appreciable. It is not a bad buy.

Prasid Banerjee



Design	78
Performance	78
Features	71
Value	90

Specifications

Display: 5.7inch QHD;
SoC: 2.15GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 820 quad-core;
RAM: 6GB; **Operating System:** Android Marshmallow; **Battery:** 3000 mAh; **Camera:** 21MP, 8MP

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